

How 20+ Search Engines Rank the World's Programming Languages

Methodology Scope

- Monthly indicator updated since 2001, tracking language popularity signals.
- Ratings derive from search hit counts across Google, Bing, Wikipedia, Amazon, and more than 20 additional web sources.
- Measures discussion and demand, not language quality or code volume.

March 2026 Editorial

TIOBE keeps search-engine methodology instead of LLM-based estimation because LLMs are trained on the same web corpus.

What Leaders Need

A data-backed picture of rank stability, momentum shifts, and concentration risk to guide hiring and platform choices.

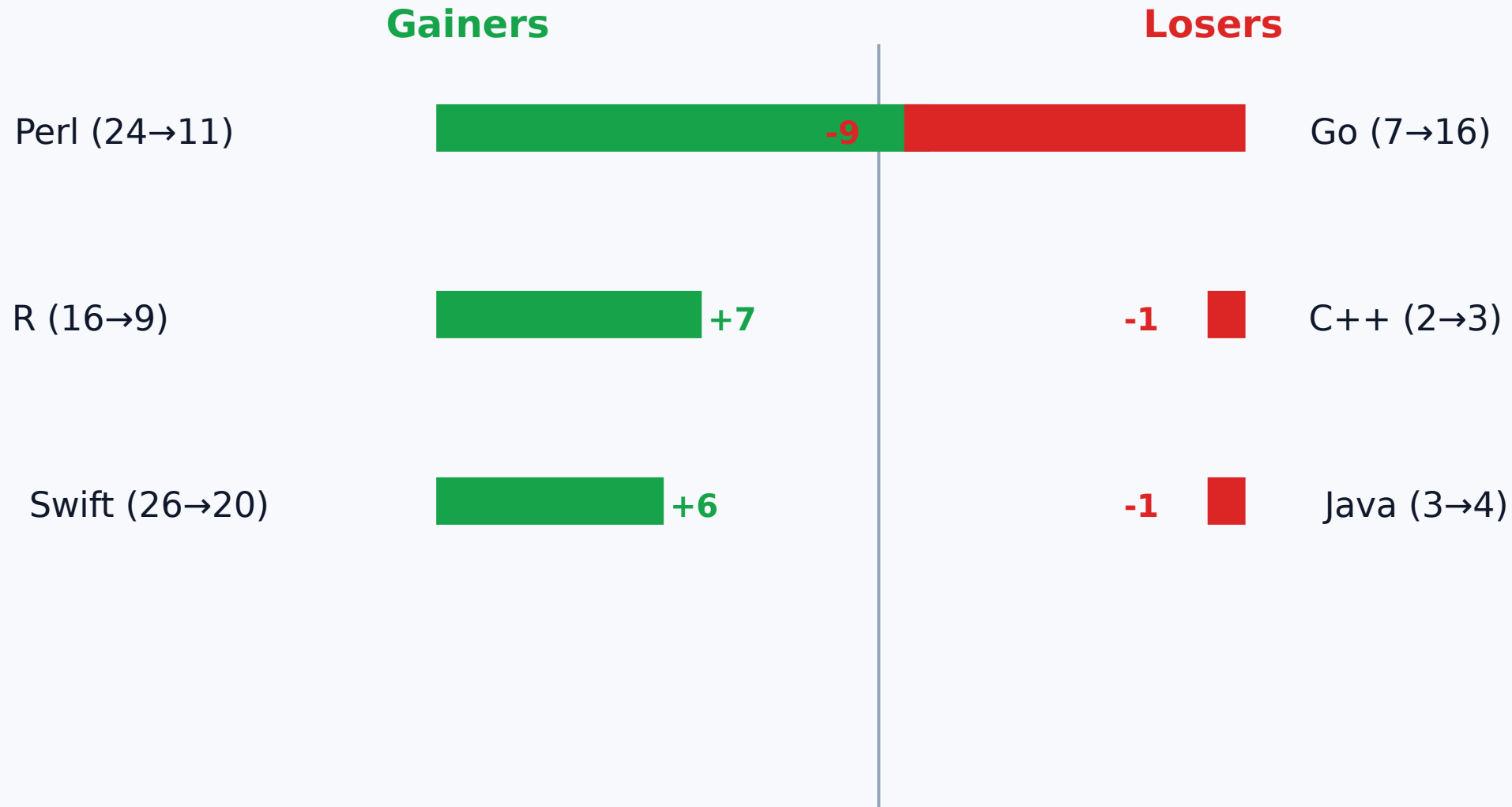
Python Holds #1 at 21.25% but C Surges to #2 with the Largest Gain

Top 20 rankings — March 2026 vs March 2025, rating and YoY change (pp)

R26	R25	Language	Rating	YoY	Relative Rating Bar
1	1	Python	21.25%	-2.59%	
2	4	C	11.55%	+2.02%	
3	2	C++	8.18%	-2.90%	
4	3	Java	7.99%	-2.37%	
5	5	C#	6.36%	+1.49%	
6	6	JavaScript	3.45%	-0.01%	
7	9	Visual Basic	2.50%	-0.02%	
8	8	SQL	2.00%	-0.57%	
9	16	R	1.88%	+0.94%	
10	10	Delphi/Object Pascal	1.80%	-0.36%	
11	24	Perl	1.75%	+1.05%	
12	12	Scratch	1.63%	-0.03%	
13	11	Fortran	1.45%	-0.25%	
14	14	Rust	1.31%	+0.09%	
15	15	MATLAB	1.29%	+0.31%	
16	7	Go	1.29%	-1.49%	
17	17	Assembly language	1.29%	+0.42%	
18	13	PHP	1.23%	-0.25%	
19	18	Ada	1.10%	+0.25%	
20	26	Swift	1.04%	+0.44%	

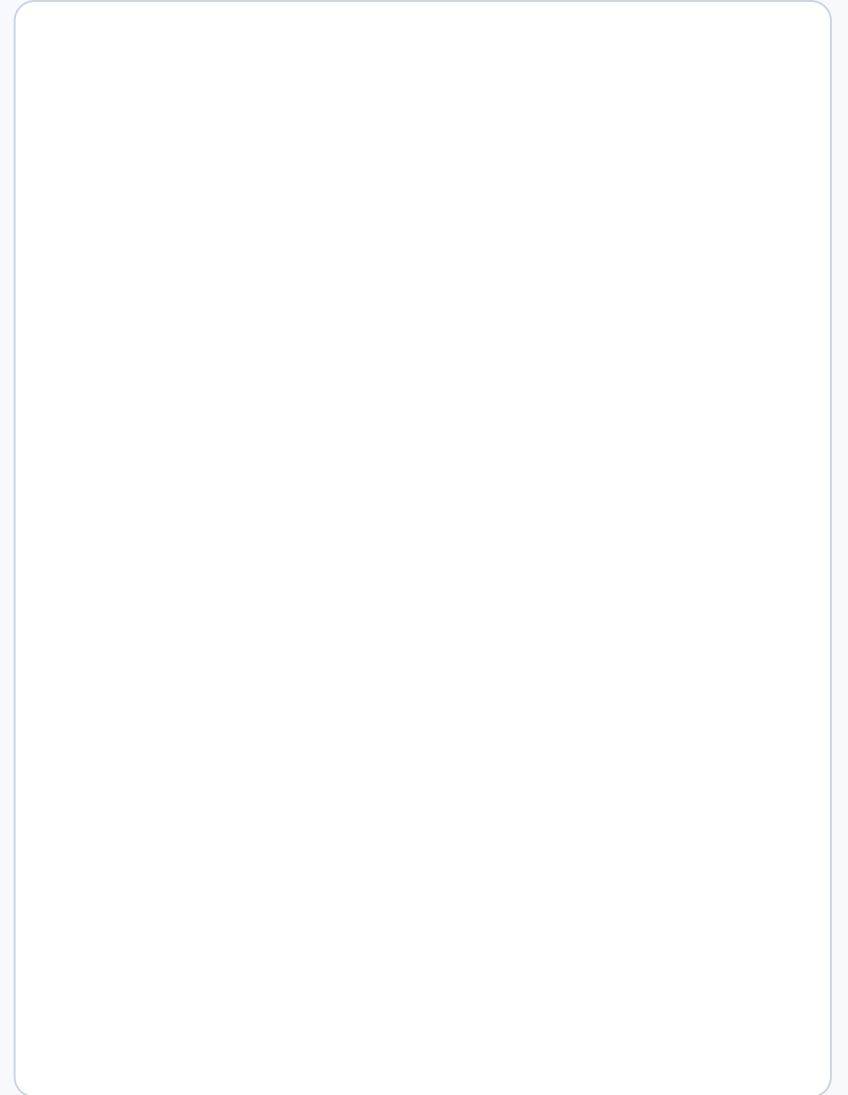
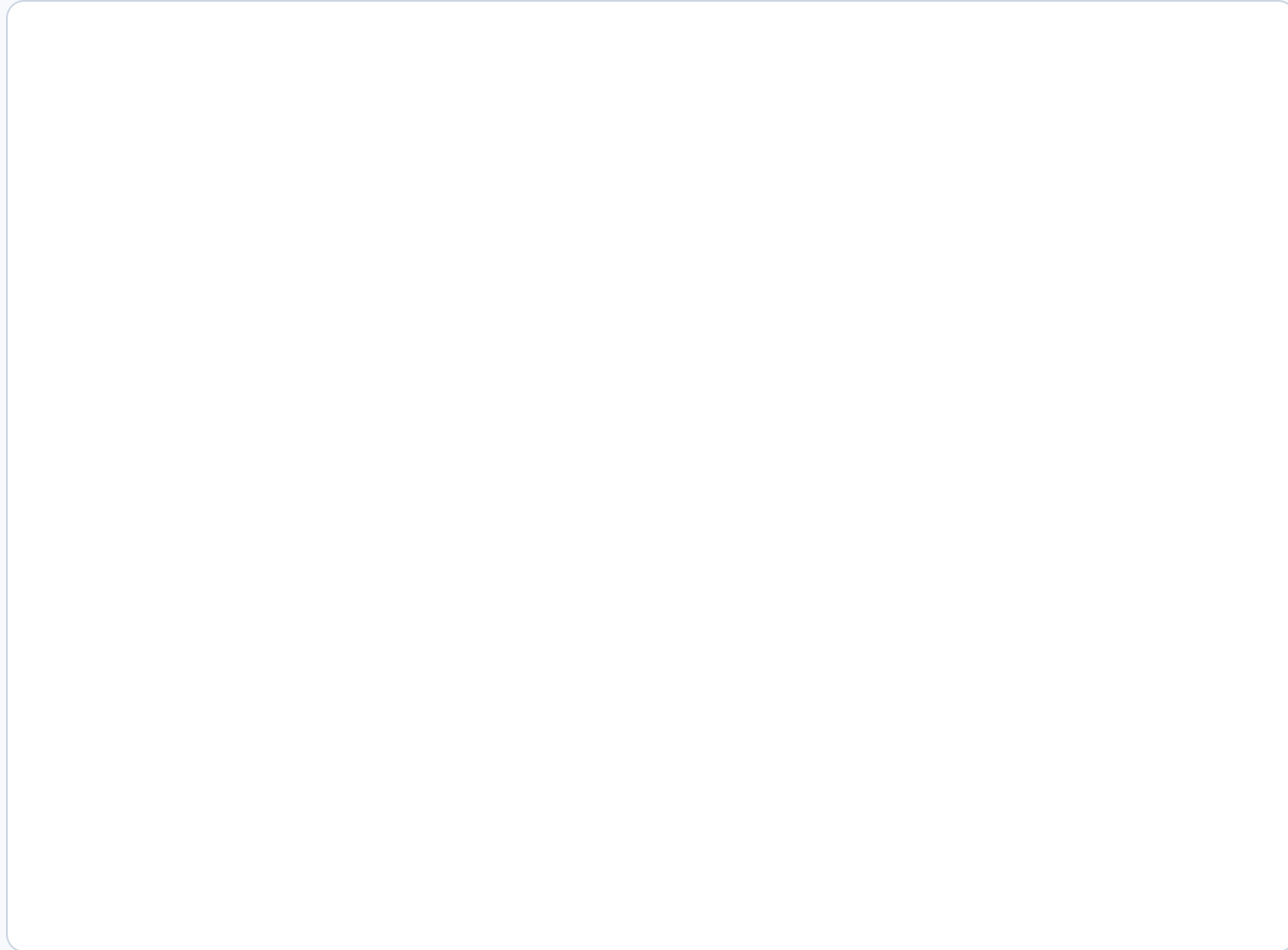
Source: TIOBE Top 20 table (Mar 2026 vs Mar 2025); Python 21.25%, C +2.02pp

Perl Jumps 13 Spots, R Climbs 7, and Go Drops 9 -- The Biggest Rank Shifts of

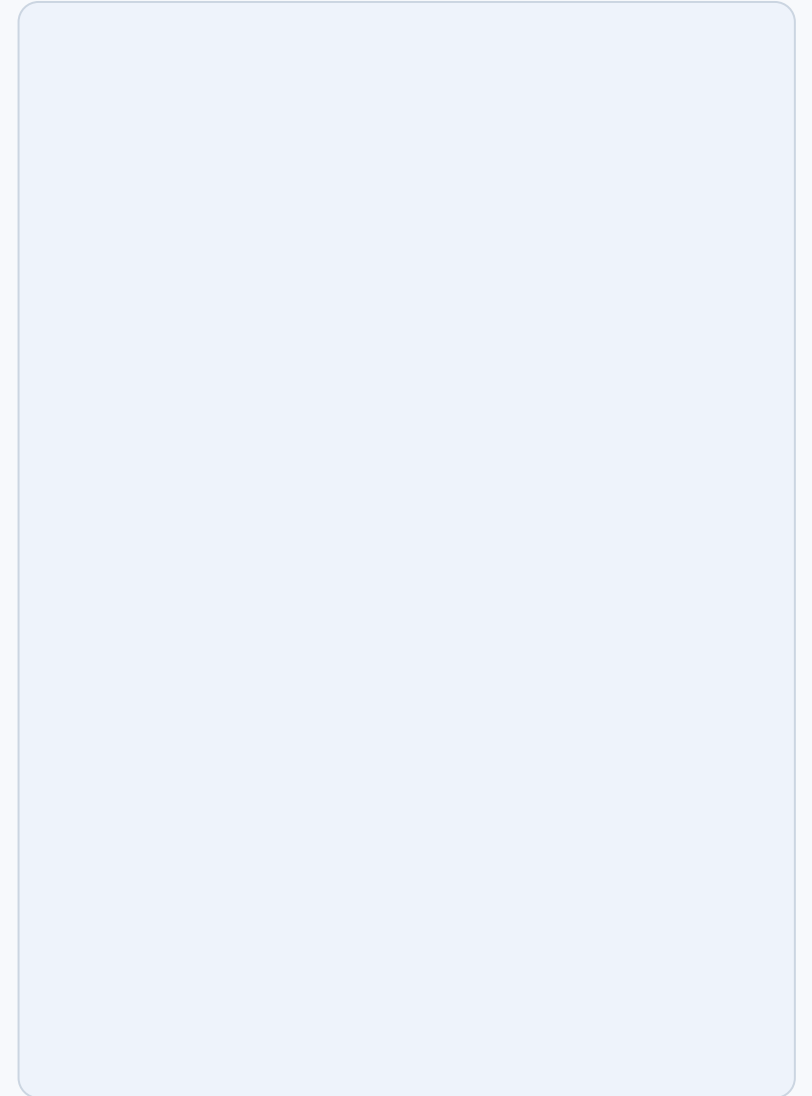
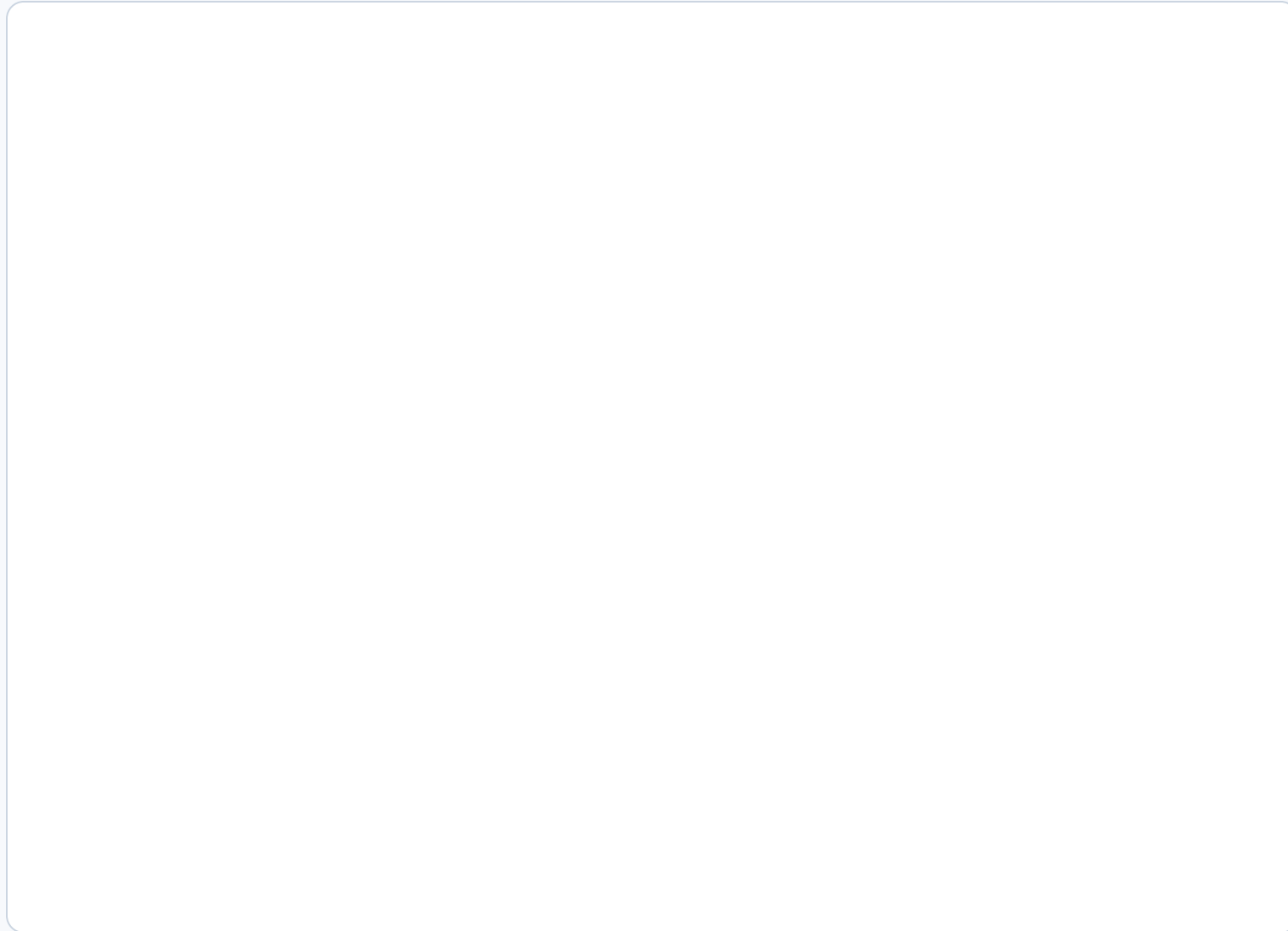


Rank shift shown as position change (positive means climbed, negative means fell)

From Lisp at #2 in 1986 to Python at #1 in 2026: How Language Rankings Shifted Over Time



Python Wins Language of the Year 6 Times -- More Than Any Other Lang



The Top 4 Languages Hold 49% of the Index: What This Means for Your T